

Aaradhyaa (Aria) Gyawali

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SUMMARY

Cornell Information Science graduate researching AI's societal and economic effects, from workforce forecasting and skill formation to platform safety and online trust, with industry experience building dashboards, forecasting tools, and text-based ML workflows for workforce planning at a global company.

EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ithaca, New York

May 2026

Bachelor of Science with Distinction in Research, Information Science (Data Science concentration), CS/AI Minor

GPA: 3.61

Courses: ML; Large Scale ML; Learning Analytics; Business Intelligence; Product Management; Tech Policy; Online Trust & Safety; Technology and Law; Microeconomics; Macroeconomics

SKILLS

Data & Analysis: Python (pandas, NumPy, PRAW), SQL, R (Shiny, ggplot2), Power BI, Excel, PySpark, Microsoft Fabric, Git

Machine Learning & NLP: Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, BERTopic, sentiment modeling, text classification pipelines, clustering

Research: Mixed-method study design, Qualtrics (conditional logic, multi-wave automation, custom JS/CSS), IRB submission and compliance, qualitative interviewing, longitudinal data governance

Others: Flask, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, API design and integration, Chrome extension development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Safety by Design Intern (Trust and Safety), Match Group, SF, Incoming

July 2026 – September 2026

- Joining the team to assess safety maturity across the portfolio of dating brands by creating a risk framework and maturity milestones.

Data Analyst (People Analytics & Workforce Insights), Encore Global, Greater Chicago

May 2024 – May 2026

- Built a Python workflow to analyze unstructured performance review text and identify succession candidates, helping 30+ executives translate qualitative feedback into workforce planning decisions.
- Developed analytics pipelines and statistical models for employee and operational data spanning 10,000+ employees across 30+ countries, improving forecast accuracy by 12%.
- Built end-to-end automated reporting pipelines using SQL, Power BI, Power Automate, and API integrations to deliver recurring performance metrics at a global scale, increasing analytics adoption by 25%.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Honors Research Thesis (Mixed-Method Research), Advisor: Prof. Claire Wardle

Sept 2025 – April 2026

- Identified gaps between user expectations and actual algorithmic behavior in online dating platforms, surfacing patterns in harm, reporting, and trust with direct implications for platform safety policy and AI-mediated product design.
- Combined a 180+ respondent Qualtrics study with large-scale analysis of 5,000+ Reddit posts (collected via PRAW) to triangulate self-reported expectations against observed community discourse.
- Applied BERTopic, sentiment modeling, and clustering to extract recurring narrative themes from noisy, high-volume social data, translating findings into interpretable patterns for research communication; managed full IRB protocol, study design, and qualitative coding.

Research Assistant, SC Johnson College of Business, Cornell University

Feb 2023 – May 2026

- Ran statistical analysis and data quality checks on multi-year longitudinal datasets; maintain documentation standards for sensitive research data across several concurrent faculty projects.
- Designed Qualtrics surveys with multi-wave email triggers, randomization, and conditional branching; wrote custom JavaScript and CSS where the native logic couldn't handle study-specific requirements.
- Facilitated 10+ group studies and one-on-one interviews; handled participant recruitment, anonymization, and IRB compliance, including protocols for studies involving deception.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Co-founder, Elevate Futures

Oct 2024 – Present

- Started a free admissions mentorship program for students in Nepal; 30+ students mentored to date, with acceptances to Harvard, Brown, and Cornell. Runs on a \$400 grant, 2:1 mentor-to-student ratio; currently expanding to Kenya.

VP, Learning and Resources Lead, Responsible AI Network, Cornell University

Oct 2023 – May 2026

- Managed an 8-person team running semester-long research and policy projects; led a study on whether people defer to AI-generated definitions of new concepts over their own initial understanding when both are presented.
- Organized an open discussion exploring how people are using AI in their work and whether their confidence in their own skills is growing or diminishing over time.

PROJECTS

Cornell Fact-Checker: Misinformation Detector

Python, ML, LLMs, Chrome API

- Co-led an 8-person team building a Chrome extension that flags potentially false claims on campus-facing web pages; owned model selection, evaluation pipeline, and scope definition for a two-semester build.

Learning Analytics Dashboard

R, Shiny, ggplot2, tidyverse

- Built a Shiny app that lets instructors see attendance and quiz trends across 123 students (2,423 records) and lets students track their own engagement by replacing a static gradebook with something both sides could actually use.

PUBLICATION

Nepal's Gen Z Used TikTok and Discord to Win a Historic Election, Tech Policy Press

Mar 2026